WorkNest Candidate Demo Script

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A 7-minute spoken walkthrough of WorkNest from a job seeker's point of view, from creating an account to applying for a job: what to click, and what to say while you do.

Before you start

Set these up at least 10 minutes before presenting, so sign-up and applying work on the first try.

- [ ] Start the server (`npm run dev` in `server/`), then the frontend (`npm run dev`); open http://localhost:5000/api/health and check it says `ok`
- [ ] Run `npm run seed` in `server/` so there are open jobs to find
- [ ] Pick a **fresh email** you have never signed up with, and have its inbox open in another tab. No Brevo set up? Keep the server terminal visible instead: the code is printed there
- [ ] Have a small PDF CV on the desktop, ready to upload
- [ ] Decide on one job to apply for (a designer role works well) and check it has screening questions
- [ ] Use an incognito window so you start logged out
- [ ] Zoom the browser to 125%, close other tabs, and turn off notifications

The script

Eight stops, about 7 minutes in total. **Do** is what you click; **Say** is what you tell the audience, in your own words.

1. Opening on the home page (30 seconds)

Do: Start logged out on the WorkNest home page. Scroll slowly past the search bar, "how it works" and the jobs open this week.

Say: "Meet Ada. She's looking for her next design job. This is the first thing she sees: a search bar, how WorkNest works in three steps, and roles that opened this week. She can browse everything without an account."

2. Creating an account (45 seconds)

Do: Click **Create Account** in the navbar. Submit the form while it's empty to show the red field messages, then fill in full name, email and password.

Say: "Signing up takes four fields. If she misses one, the form tells her exactly which, right under the field. And her password is never stored as she typed it: the server keeps only a scrambled, one-way hash."

Do (optional): Point at **Continue with Google**.

Say: "She could also just sign in with Google."

3. Verifying the email (45 seconds)

Do: Submit. On the verify page, open the email inbox (or the server terminal) and type the 6-digit code.

Say: "WorkNest emails her a 6-digit code to prove the address is real. It expires in 10 minutes, and after 5 wrong guesses she has to ask for a new one, so nobody can guess their way in. Once it's correct, she's logged straight in."

4. Building a profile (1 minute)

Do: Open the account menu (initials, top right) and click **Edit profile**. Fill in **Professional headline**, **Location**, **Years of experience**, a few skills, and upload the PDF CV.

Say: "Next she sets up her profile once: headline, location, experience, skills, job preferences and her CV. Watch the completion score climb as she fills it in. The point of doing this once is that every application can fill itself in from here."

Do: Save, then click **View profile**.

Say: "This is what a recruiter will see."

5. Finding a job (1 minute)

Do: Click **Find Jobs**. Type "designer" in the search. Then tick **Remote** under Work arrangement, and change the sort to **Closing soon**.

Say: "Now the search. As she types, results update instantly. She can filter by job type, work arrangement, experience level and career path, and sort by newest, highest salary or closing soon. Jobs past their deadline never show up here."

Do: Click the bookmark icon on one card.

Say: "She can save a job for later; WorkNest will remind her before it closes."

6. Reading the job (30 seconds)

Do: Open a job card.

Say: "The job page has everything she needs to decide: the company, location, arrangement, level, salary, responsibilities and requirements, and how many days are left to apply."

7. Applying (1.5 minutes)

This is the highlight, so slow down.

Do: Click **Apply**. On step 1, **Your details**, point out the fields are already filled in.

Say: "Here's why the profile mattered: her name, email, phone and location are already filled in. She just checks them."

Do: Click through **CV & links**; point out the CV is already attached.

Say: "Her CV and links came across too."

Do: On **Questions**, click Next with an answer empty to show the error, then answer the screening questions and the "why this role" box.

Say: "These questions were written by the recruiter for this exact role, and she has to answer every one. That's what lets recruiters compare candidates fairly."

Do: On **Review**, read the summary, then **Submit**.

Say: "One last look at everything, and she submits. She gets a confirmation on screen and by email."

8. Tracking the application (45 seconds)

Do: Click **Applications** in the navbar.

Say: "From now on, this is her home base. Every application, the stage it's at, her saved jobs, and her notifications: when a recruiter moves her forward, or a saved job is about to close, it shows up here, and stage changes are emailed to her too."

Do: Go back to that job and click **Apply** again.

Say: "And she can't apply twice by accident: WorkNest knows she already has, and takes her to her applications instead."

Closing line (15 seconds)

Say: "So in a few minutes, Ada went from a visitor to a candidate with a verified account, a reusable profile and a tracked application, without filling in the same details twice. That's the candidate side of WorkNest."

If something goes wrong

Say one sentence about what happened and keep going; the audience cares about the product, not the glitch.

What you see	Quick fix	What to say
"Network Error" toasts	The server stopped. Restart `npm run dev` in `server/`	"The server took a break; let me restart it."
The code email doesn't arrive	Read the code from the server terminal, or click resend	"Email can be slow; here's the code."
"Email already in use" on sign-up	That email was used before. Switch to your backup email	"Ada already has an account; let's use another."
Find Jobs is empty	No open jobs. Run `npm run seed`	"Let me load our demo jobs."
CV upload fails	Cloudinary isn't set up. Skip the upload and keep going	"I'll skip the CV for time."
Apply sends you to Applications	You already applied to that job. Pick a different one	"That's the duplicate check working."

Questions you may get

Question	Short answer
Do I need an account to apply?	No. Guests can apply, but with an account the form fills itself in and you can track the application.
Why verify the email?	It proves the address is real, so recruiters can reach the candidate and fake accounts are harder to make.
How is my password kept safe?	Only a bcrypt hash is stored; even the team can't see the real password.
What if I forget my password?	"Forgot password?" on the login page emails a code, then you set a new password.
Why is search so fast?	The jobs load once, and the browser filters them as you type, with no wait for the server.

Question	Short answer
Can I apply to the same job twice?	No. The database allows one application per account per job.
What file types can I upload as a CV?	PDF, DOC or DOCX, up to 5 MB, stored on Cloudinary.
How do I know if I've moved forward?	The stage updates on your Applications page, and you get an email and a notification.
What happens to a job after its deadline?	It disappears from search, and the server blocks new applications to it.